Hotel Booking Analysis – Major Project

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Project Type: Major Data Science Project

Introduction

This major project centers around a real world dataset of hotel bookings, with the aim of uncovering meaningful insights into guest behavior and booking trends. The primary objective is to analyze when people are most likely to book, how long they typically stay, what influences pricing, and what drives special requests. By diving deep into the data, I aim to identify patterns that can help hotel managers make informed decisions on pricing, capacity planning, and customer service strategies. Each section of this project addresses a key question about the booking process, supported by data analysis and visualizations.

In [6]:
```
#importring libraries
import pandas as pd
import numpy as np
```

Loading and Exploring the given dataset

In [7]:
```
# Loading dataset
df = pd.read_csv("Hotel Bookings (1) (1) (1).csv")

# Basic exploration
print(df.head())
print(df.info())
print(df.describe())
print(df.isnull().sum())
```

```
          hotel  is_canceled  lead_time  arrival_date_year arrival_date_month  \
0  Resort Hotel            0        342               2015               July
1  Resort Hotel            0        737               2015               July
2  Resort Hotel            0          7               2015               July
3  Resort Hotel            0         13               2015               July
4  Resort Hotel            0         14               2015               July

   arrival_date_week_number  arrival_date_day_of_month  \
0                        27                          1
1                        27                          1
2                        27                          1
3                        27                          1
4                        27                          1

   stays_in_weekend_nights  stays_in_week_nights  adults  ...  deposit_type  \
0                        0                     0       2  ...    No Deposit
1                        0                     0       2  ...    No Deposit
2                        0                     1       1  ...    No Deposit
3                        0                     1       1  ...    No Deposit
4                        0                     2       2  ...    No Deposit

   agent company days_in_waiting_list customer_type   adr  \
0    NaN     NaN                    0     Transient   0.0
1    NaN     NaN                    0     Transient   0.0
2    NaN     NaN                    0     Transient  75.0
3  304.0     NaN                    0     Transient  75.0
4  240.0     NaN                    0     Transient  98.0

   required_car_parking_spaces  total_of_special_requests  reservation_status  \
0                            0                          0           Check-Out
1                            0                          0           Check-Out
2                            0                          0           Check-Out
3                            0                          0           Check-Out
4                            0                          1           Check-Out

  reservation_status_date
0              2015-07-01
1              2015-07-01
2              2015-07-02
3              2015-07-02
4              2015-07-03

[5 rows x 32 columns]
<class 'pandas.core.frame.DataFrame'>
RangeIndex: 119390 entries, 0 to 119389
Data columns (total 32 columns):
 #   Column                          Non-Null Count   Dtype
---  ------                          --------------   -----
 0   hotel                           119390 non-null  object
 1   is_canceled                     119390 non-null  int64
 2   lead_time                       119390 non-null  int64
 3   arrival_date_year               119390 non-null  int64
 4   arrival_date_month              119390 non-null  object
 5   arrival_date_week_number        119390 non-null  int64
 6   arrival_date_day_of_month       119390 non-null  int64
 7   stays_in_weekend_nights         119390 non-null  int64
```

```
 8   stays_in_week_nights            119390 non-null  int64
 9   adults                          119390 non-null  int64
 10  children                        119386 non-null  float64
 11  babies                          119390 non-null  int64
 12  meal                            119390 non-null  object
 13  country                         118902 non-null  object
 14  market_segment                  119390 non-null  object
 15  distribution_channel            119390 non-null  object
 16  is_repeated_guest               119390 non-null  int64
 17  previous_cancellations          119390 non-null  int64
 18  previous_bookings_not_canceled  119390 non-null  int64
 19  reserved_room_type              119390 non-null  object
 20  assigned_room_type              119390 non-null  object
 21  booking_changes                 119390 non-null  int64
 22  deposit_type                    119390 non-null  object
 23  agent                           103050 non-null  float64
 24  company                         6797 non-null    float64
 25  days_in_waiting_list            119390 non-null  int64
 26  customer_type                   119390 non-null  object
 27  adr                             119390 non-null  float64
 28  required_car_parking_spaces     119390 non-null  int64
 29  total_of_special_requests       119390 non-null  int64
 30  reservation_status              119390 non-null  object
 31  reservation_status_date         119390 non-null  object
dtypes: float64(4), int64(16), object(12)
memory usage: 29.1+ MB
None
         is_canceled      lead_time  arrival_date_year  \
count  119390.000000  119390.000000      119390.000000
mean        0.370416     104.011416        2016.156554
std         0.482918     106.863097           0.707476
min         0.000000       0.000000        2015.000000
25%         0.000000      18.000000        2016.000000
50%         0.000000      69.000000        2016.000000
75%         1.000000     160.000000        2017.000000
max         1.000000     737.000000        2017.000000

       arrival_date_week_number  arrival_date_day_of_month  \
count             119390.000000              119390.000000
mean                 27.165173                  15.798241
std                  13.605138                   8.780829
min                   1.000000                   1.000000
25%                  16.000000                   8.000000
50%                  28.000000                  16.000000
75%                  38.000000                  23.000000
max                  53.000000                  31.000000

       stays_in_weekend_nights  stays_in_week_nights         adults  \
count            119390.000000         119390.000000  119390.000000
mean                 0.927599              2.500302       1.856403
std                  0.998613              1.908286       0.579261
min                  0.000000              0.000000       0.000000
25%                  0.000000              1.000000       2.000000
50%                  1.000000              2.000000       2.000000
75%                  2.000000              3.000000       2.000000
max                 19.000000             50.000000      55.000000
```

```
            children         babies  is_repeated_guest  \
count  119386.000000  119390.000000      119390.000000
mean        0.103890       0.007949           0.031912
std         0.398561       0.097436           0.175767
min         0.000000       0.000000           0.000000
25%         0.000000       0.000000           0.000000
50%         0.000000       0.000000           0.000000
75%         0.000000       0.000000           0.000000
max        10.000000      10.000000           1.000000

       previous_cancellations  previous_bookings_not_canceled  \
count           119390.000000                   119390.000000
mean                 0.087118                        0.137097
std                  0.844336                        1.497437
min                  0.000000                        0.000000
25%                  0.000000                        0.000000
50%                  0.000000                        0.000000
75%                  0.000000                        0.000000
max                 26.000000                       72.000000

       booking_changes          agent      company  days_in_waiting_list  \
count    119390.000000  103050.000000  6797.000000         119390.000000
mean          0.221124      86.693382   189.266735              2.321149
std           0.652306     110.774548   131.655015             17.594721
min           0.000000       1.000000     6.000000              0.000000
25%           0.000000       9.000000    62.000000              0.000000
50%           0.000000      14.000000   179.000000              0.000000
75%           0.000000     229.000000   270.000000              0.000000
max          21.000000     535.000000   543.000000            391.000000

                 adr  required_car_parking_spaces  total_of_special_requests
count  119390.000000                119390.000000              119390.000000
mean      101.831122                     0.062518                   0.571363
std        50.535790                     0.245291                   0.792798
min        -6.380000                     0.000000                   0.000000
25%        69.290000                     0.000000                   0.000000
50%        94.575000                     0.000000                   0.000000
75%       126.000000                     0.000000                   1.000000
max      5400.000000                     8.000000                   5.000000
hotel                                  0
is_canceled                            0
lead_time                              0
arrival_date_year                      0
arrival_date_month                     0
arrival_date_week_number               0
arrival_date_day_of_month              0
stays_in_weekend_nights                0
stays_in_week_nights                   0
adults                                 0
children                               4
babies                                 0
meal                                   0
country                              488
market_segment                         0
distribution_channel                   0
```

```
is_repeated_guest                     0
previous_cancellations                0
previous_bookings_not_canceled        0
reserved_room_type                    0
assigned_room_type                    0
booking_changes                       0
deposit_type                          0
agent                             16340
company                          112593
days_in_waiting_list                  0
customer_type                         0
adr                                   0
required_car_parking_spaces           0
total_of_special_requests             0
reservation_status                    0
reservation_status_date               0
dtype: int64
hotel                                 0
is_canceled                           0
lead_time                             0
arrival_date_year                     0
arrival_date_month                    0
arrival_date_week_number              0
arrival_date_day_of_month             0
stays_in_weekend_nights               0
stays_in_week_nights                  0
adults                                0
children                              4
babies                                0
meal                                  0
country                             488
market_segment                        0
distribution_channel                  0
is_repeated_guest                     0
previous_cancellations                0
previous_bookings_not_canceled        0
reserved_room_type                    0
assigned_room_type                    0
booking_changes                       0
deposit_type                          0
agent                             16340
company                          112593
days_in_waiting_list                  0
customer_type                         0
adr                                   0
required_car_parking_spaces           0
total_of_special_requests             0
reservation_status                    0
reservation_status_date               0
dtype: int64
```

Data Cleaning

In [5]:
```
# Make a copy of the original dataframe to avoid the modifying of the raw data
df_clean = df.copy()
```

```
# Combine year, month, and day into a single datetime column called 'arrival_date'
df_clean['arrival_date'] = pd.to_datetime(
    df_clean['arrival_date_year'].astype(str) + '/' +                 # Convert yea
    df_clean['arrival_date_month'] + '/' +                            # Use month n
    df_clean['arrival_date_day_of_month'].astype(str),               # Convert day
    errors='coerce'                                                   # If conversi
)

# Convert 'reservation_status_date' column to proper datetime format
df_clean['reservation_status_date'] = pd.to_datetime(
    df_clean['reservation_status_date'],
    errors='coerce'                                                   # Handle any
)

# Fill missing values in the 'children' column with 0, assuming there were no child
df_clean['children'].fillna(0, inplace=True)

# Fill missing values in 'country' with 'Unknown' so that blank countries are not l
df_clean['country'].fillna('Unknown', inplace=True)

# Fill missing values in 'agent' column with 0 (assume 0 = unknown or no agent used
df_clean['agent'].fillna(0, inplace=True)

# Fill missing values in 'company' column with 0 (assume 0 = no company associated)
df_clean['company'].fillna(0, inplace=True)

# Create a new column 'total_nights' that adds up week and weekend night stays
df_clean['total_nights'] = (
    df_clean['stays_in_weekend_nights'] +
    df_clean['stays_in_week_nights']
)

# Optionally,savimg the cleaned dataset to a new CSV file
df_clean.to_csv("Cleaned_Hotel_Bookings.csv", index=False)  # index=False avoids wr

cleaned_df = pd.read_csv("Cleaned_Hotel_Bookings.csv")
cleaned_df
```

```
C:\Users\Aksh Modgill\AppData\Local\Temp\ipykernel_18076\1104371635.py:19: FutureWar
ning: A value is trying to be set on a copy of a DataFrame or Series through chained
assignment using an inplace method.
The behavior will change in pandas 3.0. This inplace method will never work because
the intermediate object on which we are setting values always behaves as a copy.

For example, when doing 'df[col].method(value, inplace=True)', try using 'df.method
({col: value}, inplace=True)' or df[col] = df[col].method(value) instead, to perform
the operation inplace on the original object.


  df_clean['children'].fillna(0, inplace=True)
C:\Users\Aksh Modgill\AppData\Local\Temp\ipykernel_18076\1104371635.py:22: FutureWar
ning: A value is trying to be set on a copy of a DataFrame or Series through chained
assignment using an inplace method.
The behavior will change in pandas 3.0. This inplace method will never work because
the intermediate object on which we are setting values always behaves as a copy.

For example, when doing 'df[col].method(value, inplace=True)', try using 'df.method
({col: value}, inplace=True)' or df[col] = df[col].method(value) instead, to perform
the operation inplace on the original object.


  df_clean['country'].fillna('Unknown', inplace=True)
C:\Users\Aksh Modgill\AppData\Local\Temp\ipykernel_18076\1104371635.py:25: FutureWar
ning: A value is trying to be set on a copy of a DataFrame or Series through chained
assignment using an inplace method.
The behavior will change in pandas 3.0. This inplace method will never work because
the intermediate object on which we are setting values always behaves as a copy.

For example, when doing 'df[col].method(value, inplace=True)', try using 'df.method
({col: value}, inplace=True)' or df[col] = df[col].method(value) instead, to perform
the operation inplace on the original object.


  df_clean['agent'].fillna(0, inplace=True)
C:\Users\Aksh Modgill\AppData\Local\Temp\ipykernel_18076\1104371635.py:28: FutureWar
ning: A value is trying to be set on a copy of a DataFrame or Series through chained
assignment using an inplace method.
The behavior will change in pandas 3.0. This inplace method will never work because
the intermediate object on which we are setting values always behaves as a copy.

For example, when doing 'df[col].method(value, inplace=True)', try using 'df.method
({col: value}, inplace=True)' or df[col] = df[col].method(value) instead, to perform
the operation inplace on the original object.


  df_clean['company'].fillna(0, inplace=True)
```

Out[5]:

	hotel	is_canceled	lead_time	arrival_date_year	arrival_date_month	arrival_date_w
0	Resort Hotel	0	342	2015	July	
1	Resort Hotel	0	737	2015	July	
2	Resort Hotel	0	7	2015	July	
3	Resort Hotel	0	13	2015	July	
4	Resort Hotel	0	14	2015	July	
...	...	...	...	...	...	
119385	City Hotel	0	23	2017	August	
119386	City Hotel	0	102	2017	August	
119387	City Hotel	0	34	2017	August	
119388	City Hotel	0	109	2017	August	
119389	City Hotel	0	205	2017	August	

119390 rows × 34 columns

Data Analysis

1.Prime time to secure a hotel room

In [12]:

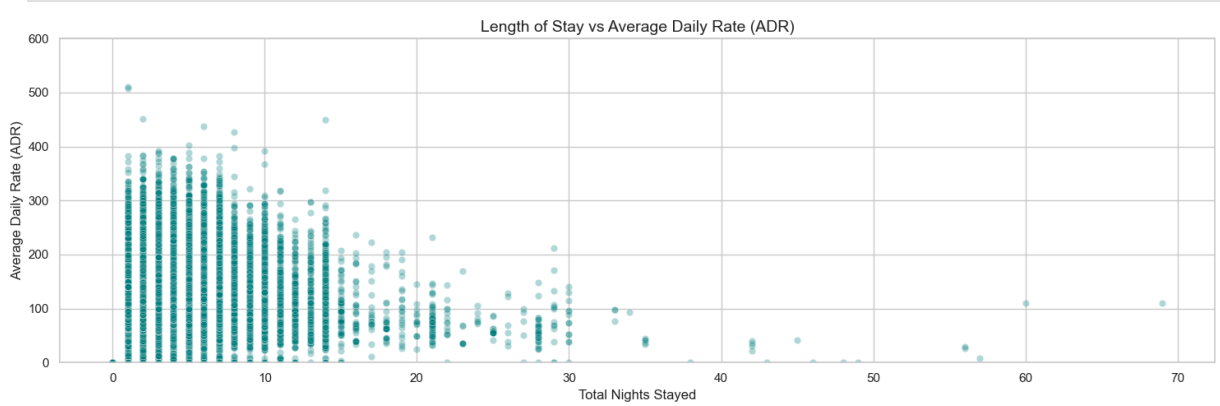
```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns

sns.set(style="whitegrid")# Set the style of seaborn plots
monthly_bookings = df_clean['arrival_date'].dt.month.value_counts().sort_index()# C

plt.figure(figsize=(10, 5)) #  size of the plot
monthly_bookings.plot(kind='bar', color='skyblue') # Create a bar plot for monthly
plt.title('Hotel Bookings Per Month')
plt.xlabel('Month')
plt.ylabel('Number of Bookings')
plt.xticks(ticks=range(0, 12) # Set x-ticks to represent months
           , labels=[
```

```
    'Jan', 'Feb', 'Mar', 'Apr', 'May', 'Jun',
    'Jul', 'Aug', 'Sep', 'Oct', 'Nov', 'Dec'], rotation=45) # Rotate x-tick labels
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```

The graph shows that the prime time for hotel bookings is during the summer, specifically July and August ,August being the highest.

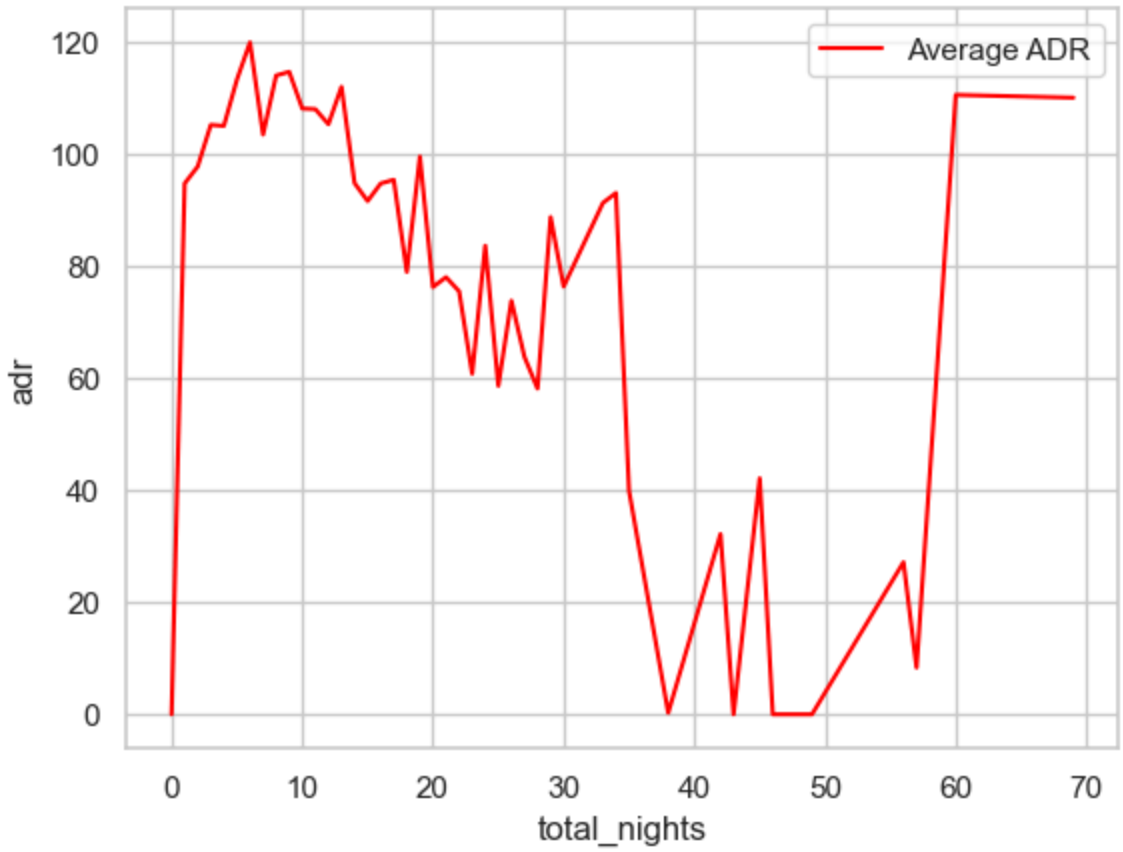
2.The ideal length of stay for best rates

In [61]:
```
df['total_nights'] = df['stays_in_weekend_nights'] + df['stays_in_week_nights'] # C

# Step 2: Create the scatter plot
plt.figure(figsize=(15, 5))  # Set plot size
sns.scatterplot(x='total_nights', y='adr', data=df, alpha=0.3, color='teal')  # Ada
plt.title('Length of Stay vs Average Daily Rate (ADR)', fontsize=14)
plt.xlabel('Total Nights Stayed', fontsize=12)
plt.ylabel('Average Daily Rate (ADR)', fontsize=12)
plt.ylim(0,600)  # Set y-axis limit to focus on ADR values
plt.grid(True)  # Optional: adds a light grid
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```



In [21]:
```
# Add average daily rate line per night length
avg_rates = df.groupby('total_nights')['adr'].mean().reset_index() # Calculate aver
sns.lineplot(x='total_nights', y='adr', data=avg_rates, color='red', label='Average
```

Out[21]: <Axes: xlabel='total_nights', ylabel='adr'>



Most bookings are short stays (1–10 nights), as shown by the density of points on the left.

While longer stays don't always result in cheaper rates, they do show more variation in price.

longer stays can sometimes be cheaper per night, but not consistently

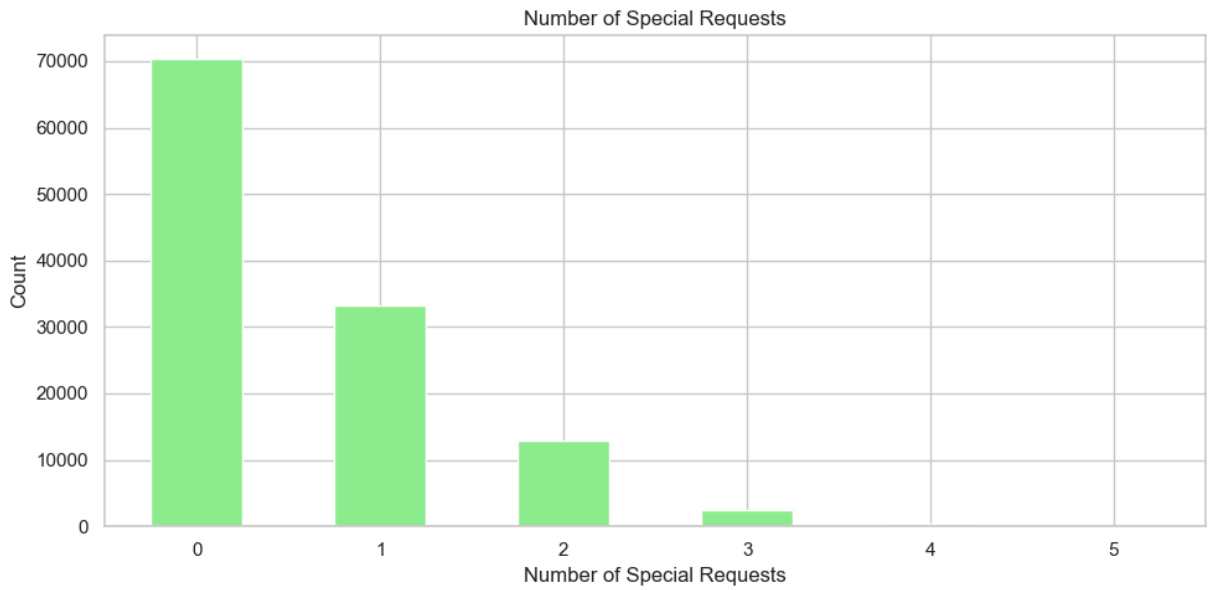
3.Factors leading to special requests for a hotel

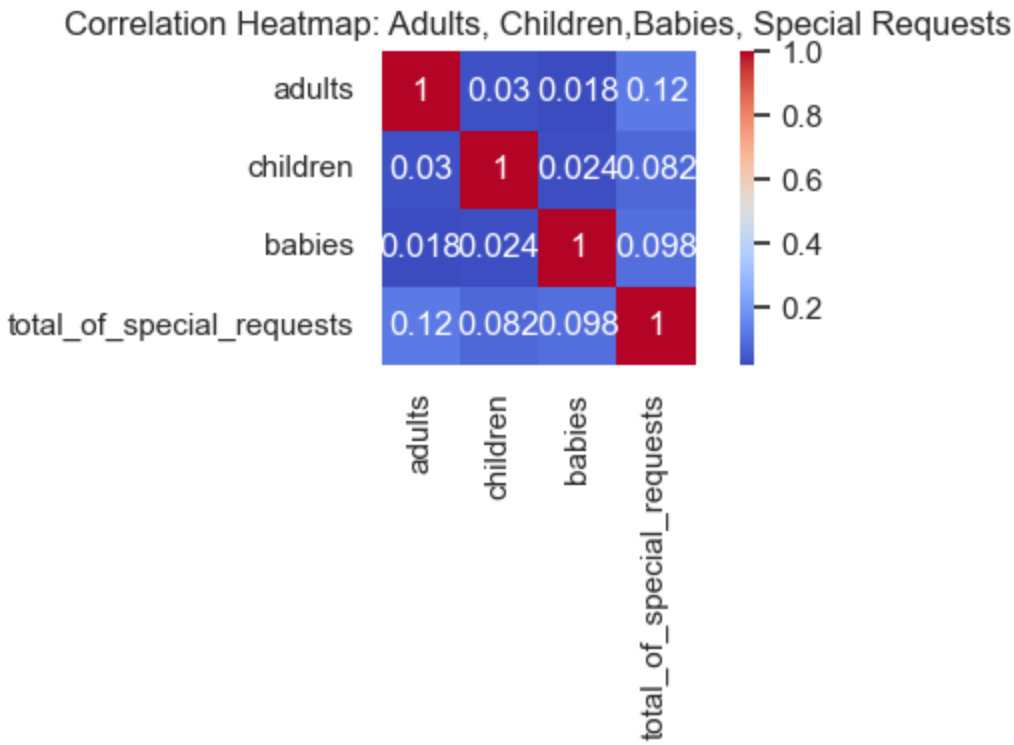
3.1 Number of guests

In [48]:
```
# bar plot for the number of special requests
special_requests_count = df_clean['total_of_special_requests'].value_counts().sort_
plt.figure(figsize=(10, 5))
special_requests_count.plot(kind='bar', color='lightgreen')
plt.title('Number of Special Requests')
plt.xlabel('Number of Special Requests')
plt.ylabel('Count')
plt.xticks(rotation=0)  # Rotate x-tick labels for better readability
```

```
plt.tight_layout()

# Factors : 1. Number of people staying in the hotel
# Select only the relevant columns
cols_of_interest = df[['adults', 'children','babies', 'total_of_special_requests']]

# Calculate the correlation matrix
correlation_new = cols_of_interest.corr()

# Display correlation of adults and children with total_of_special_requests
print("Correlation with total_of_special_requests \n", correlation_new['total_of_sp

plt.figure(figsize=(6, 4))
sns.heatmap(correlation_new, annot=True, cmap='coolwarm',  square=True)
plt.title("Correlation Heatmap: Adults, Children,Babies, Special Requests")
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```

```
Correlation with total_of_special_requests
 adults      0.122884
children    0.081745
babies      0.097889
Name: total_of_special_requests, dtype: float64
```





More people in a booking ,especially families tend to make more requests (extra beds, connecting rooms, etc.). Though the correlation is not very strong, it is positive and consistent across guest types.

3.2 Type of hotel

In [49]:
```
# Compare average number of special requests by hotel type
hotel_requests = df.groupby('hotel')['total_of_special_requests'].mean().reset_inde
print(hotel_requests)

# Visualization
sns.barplot(x='hotel', y='total_of_special_requests', data=hotel_requests)
plt.title("Average Special Requests by Hotel Type")
plt.xlabel("Hotel Type")
plt.ylabel("Average Special Requests")
plt.show()
```

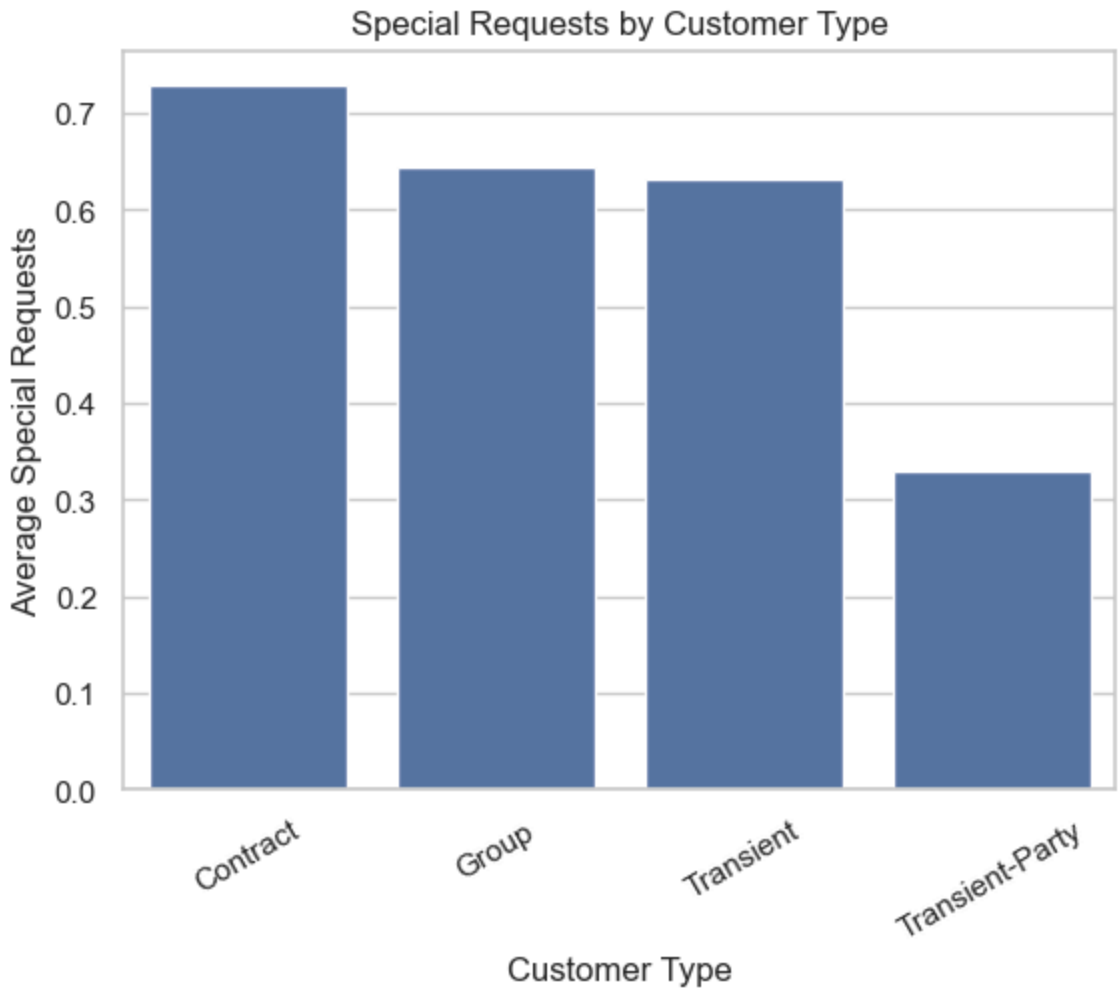
```
         hotel  total_of_special_requests
0    City Hotel                   0.546918
1  Resort Hotel                   0.619770
```

Resort hotels usually have more special requests as they serve guests on leisure or holiday trips, who are more likely to request extra facilities such as room preferences, late check-outs, special views etc.

3.3 Customer Type

In [50]:
```
# Average special requests by customer type
customer_requests = df.groupby('customer_type')['total_of_special_requests'].mean()
print(customer_requests)

# Visualization
sns.barplot(x='customer_type', y='total_of_special_requests', data=customer_request
plt.title("Special Requests by Customer Type")
plt.xlabel("Customer Type")
plt.ylabel("Average Special Requests")
plt.xticks(rotation=30)
plt.show()
```

```
    customer_type  total_of_special_requests
0        Contract                   0.728901
1           Group                   0.644714
2       Transient                   0.631582
3  Transient-Party                  0.329327
```

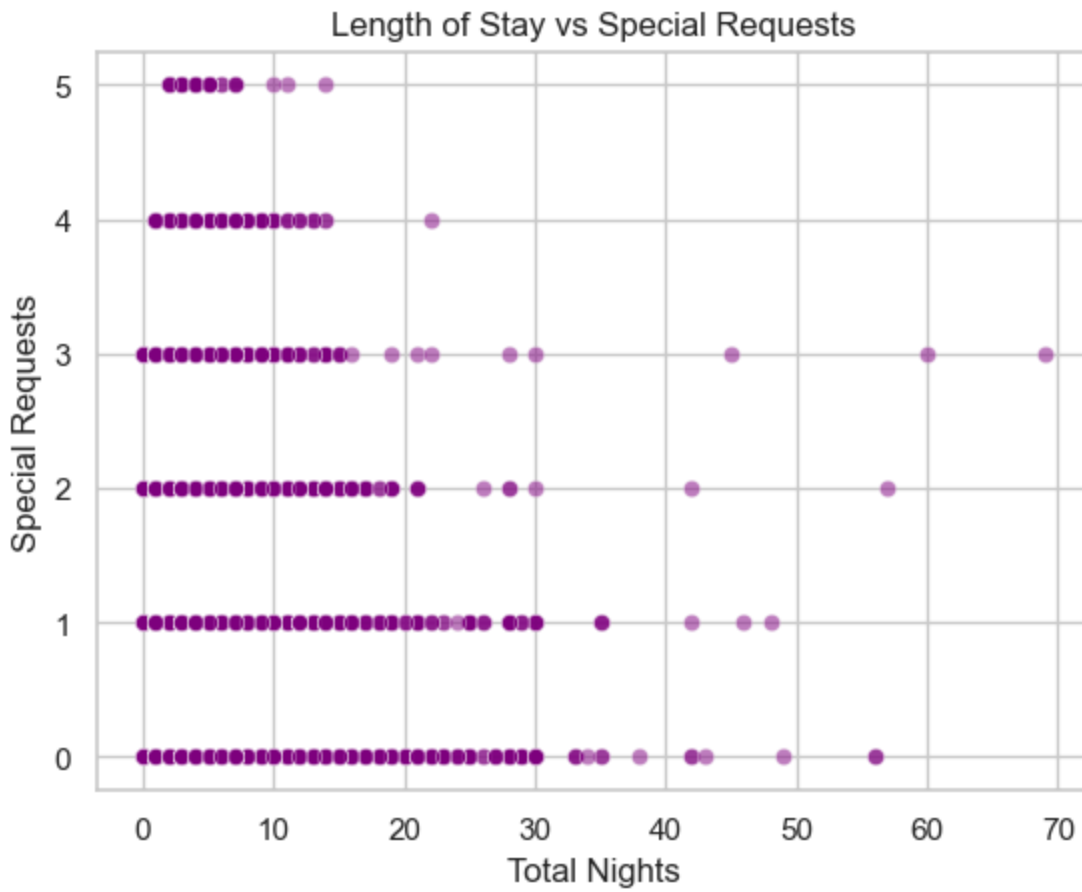


Contract and group customers makes more special requests as they might have specific requirements, possibly negotiated in bulk (e.g. meal preferences, parking, rooms on same floor). Transient-party guests show fewer requests, possibly due to less familiarity or urgency.

3.4 Length of Stay

In [52]:
```
# First create total_nights if not already created
df['total_nights'] = df['stays_in_week_nights'] + df['stays_in_weekend_nights']

# Check correlation
correlation = df[['total_nights', 'total_of_special_requests']].corr()
print(correlation)

# Scatterplot
sns.scatterplot(x='total_nights', y='total_of_special_requests', data=df, alpha=0.5
plt.title("Length of Stay vs Special Requests")
plt.xlabel("Total Nights")
plt.ylabel("Special Requests")
plt.show()
```

```
                          total_nights  total_of_special_requests
total_nights                  1.000000                   0.079259
total_of_special_requests     0.079259                   1.000000
```

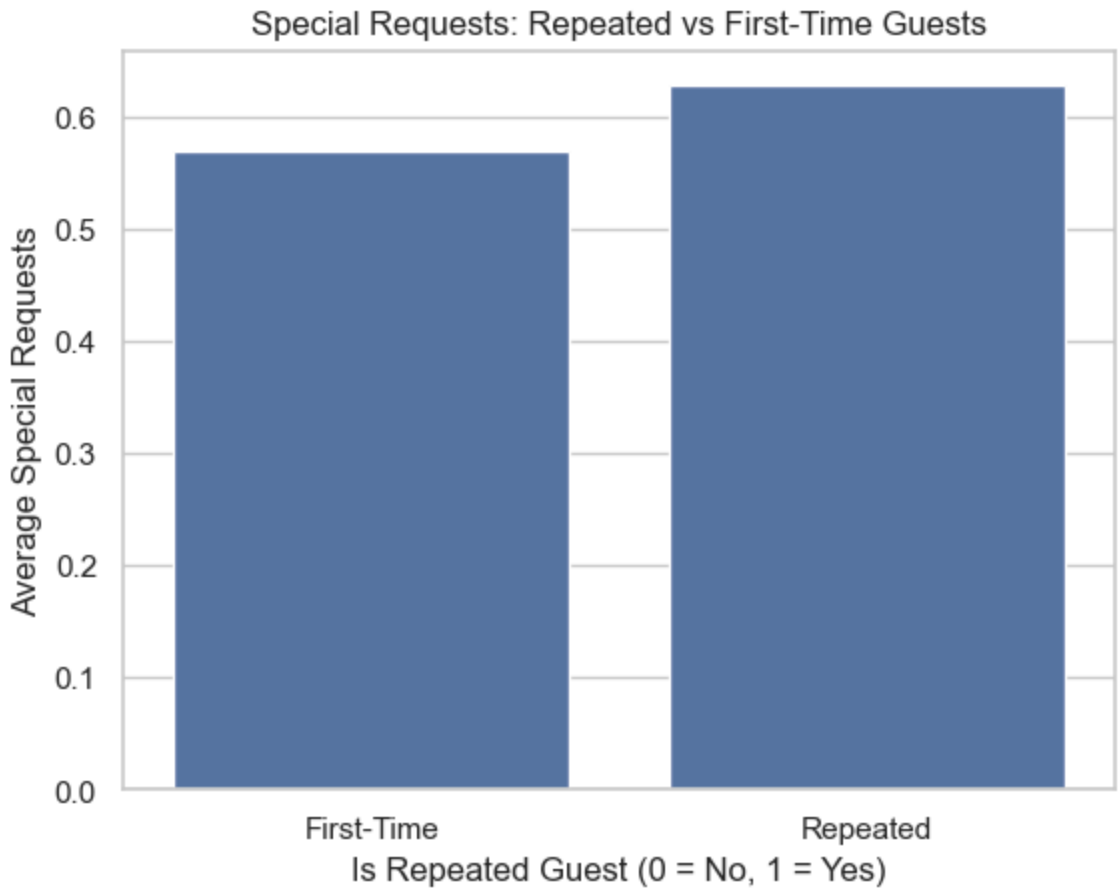


Longer stays may lead to more requests for service (e.g. room cleaning frequency, fridge access). However, the low correlation suggests this is not a primary driver.

3.5 Repeated guest status

In [53]:
```
# Average special requests by repeated guest status
repeat_requests = df.groupby('is_repeated_guest')['total_of_special_requests'].mean
print(repeat_requests)

# Visualization
sns.barplot(x='is_repeated_guest', y='total_of_special_requests', data=repeat_reque
plt.title("Special Requests: Repeated vs First-Time Guests")
plt.xlabel("Is Repeated Guest (0 = No, 1 = Yes)")
plt.ylabel("Average Special Requests")
plt.xticks([0, 1], ["First-Time", "Repeated"])
plt.show()
```

```
   is_repeated_guest  total_of_special_requests
0                  0                   0.569484
1                  1                   0.628346
```

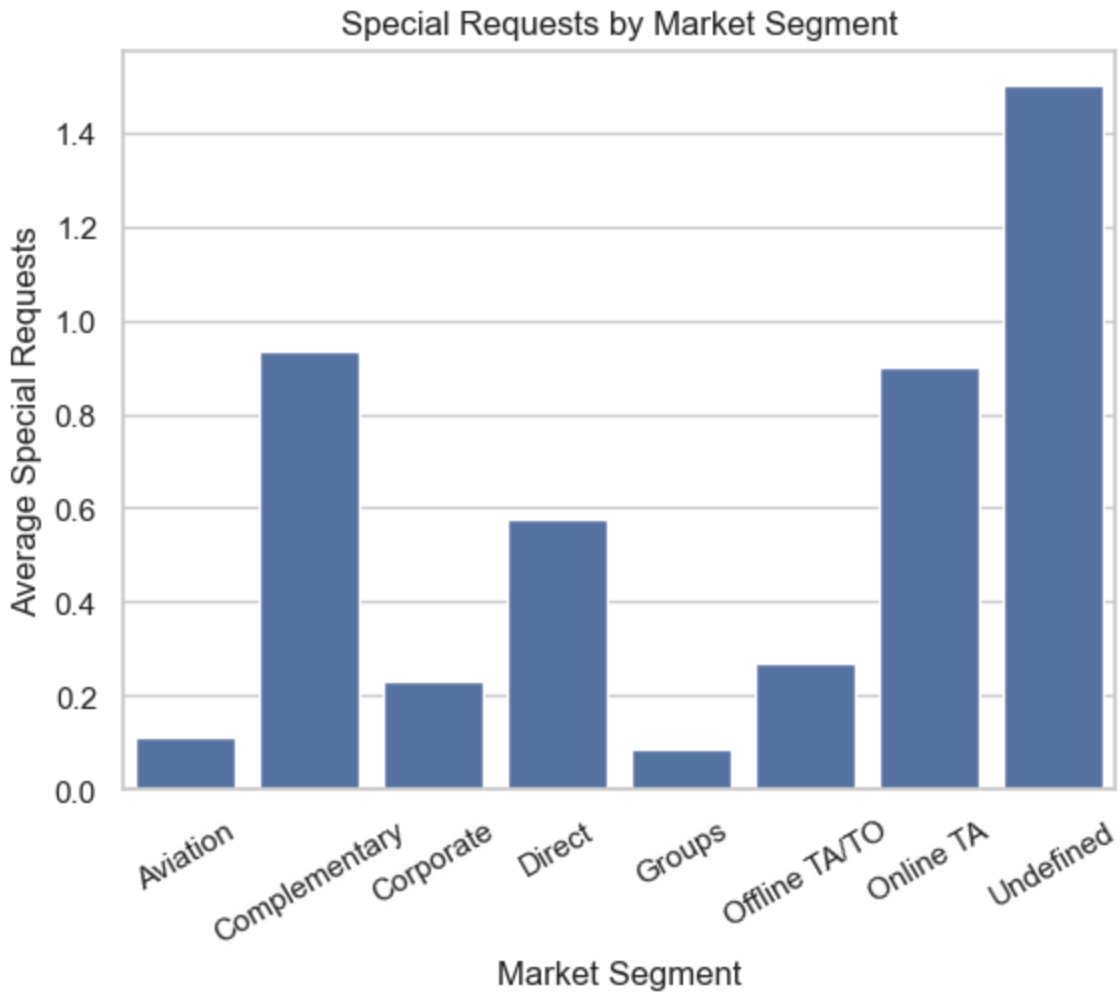


Repeated guests often ask for more number of special requestand are more likely to know what they want and feel more confident requesting it (e.g., same room as last time, early check-in, etc.).

3.6 Market Segment

In [54]:
```
# Average special requests by market segment
segment_requests = df.groupby('market_segment')['total_of_special_requests'].mean()
print(segment_requests)

# Visualization
sns.barplot(x='market_segment', y='total_of_special_requests', data=segment_request
plt.title("Special Requests by Market Segment")
plt.xlabel("Market Segment")
plt.ylabel("Average Special Requests")
plt.xticks(rotation=30)
plt.show()
```

```
  market_segment  total_of_special_requests
0       Aviation                   0.113924
1  Complementary                   0.932705
2      Corporate                   0.229839
3         Direct                   0.576075
4         Groups                   0.087174
5  Offline TA/TO                   0.268013
6      Online TA                   0.899393
7      Undefined                   1.500000
```

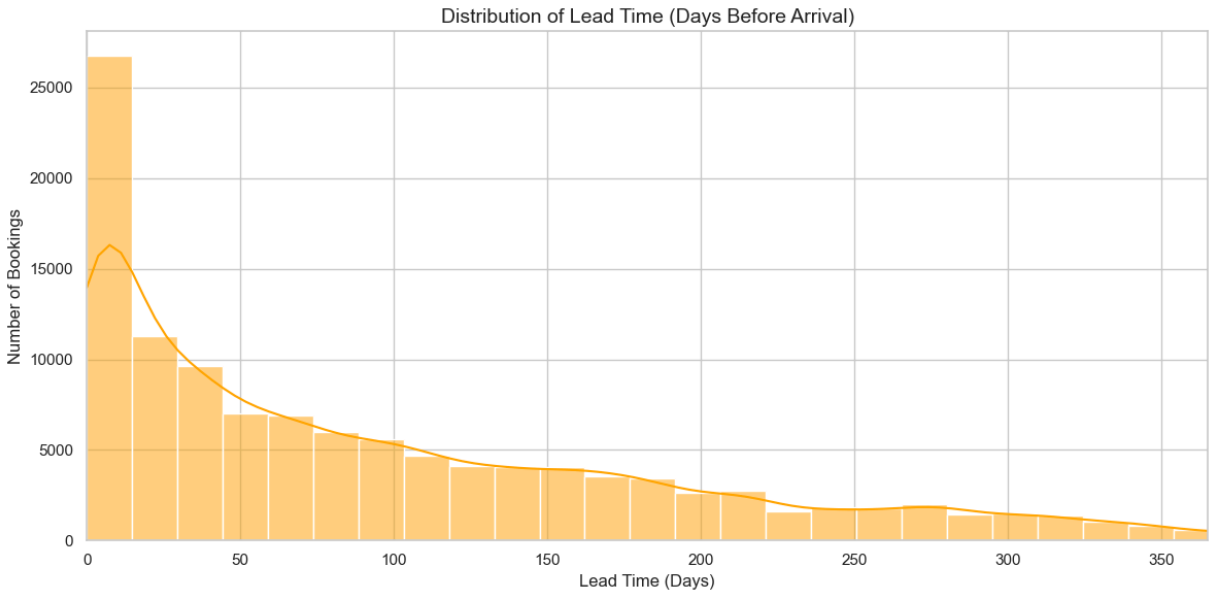


Guests coming from online travel agents (OTA) or special complimentary arrangements tend to avail more special requests as they want to get the maxiumum benefits available as they are paying for the same to travel agents and complimentary facilities everyone will like to avail maximum of those. Undefined segment's value can be an outlier, or there might be any other reason for the same.

4. When are bookings typically made?

In [58]:
```
# Plot the distribution of lead_time
plt.figure(figsize=(12, 6))
sns.histplot(df['lead_time'], bins=50, kde=True, color='orange') #kde=True adds a k

# Add titles and labels
```

```
plt.title('Distribution of Lead Time (Days Before Arrival)', fontsize=14)
plt.xlabel('Lead Time (Days)', fontsize=12)
plt.ylabel('Number of Bookings', fontsize=12)

# To ignore extremely high values)
plt.xlim(0, 365)

plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```



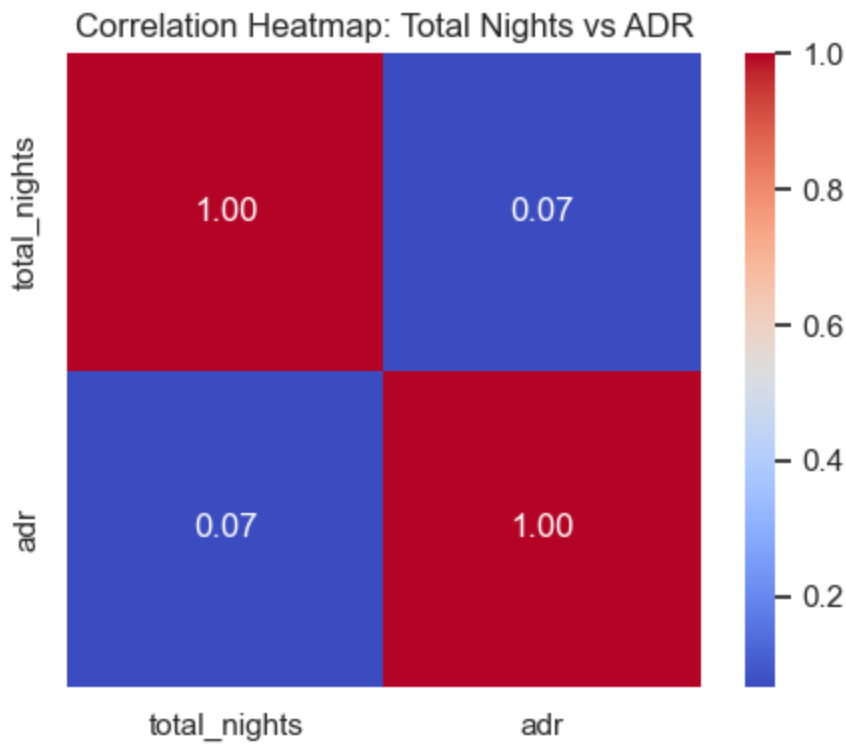
The highest peak is between 0 to 15 days , after that booking steadily declines and only a small portion of guests book their stays more than 6 months in advance. While some guests plan months ahead, short-notice bookings are far more common, suggesting that hotels should prioritize flexibility and last-minute availability in their reservation strategy.

5. How does length of stay correlate with daily rates

In [59]:
```
df['total_nights'] = df['stays_in_weekend_nights'] + df['stays_in_week_nights']

# Select the relevant columns
stay_adr_df = df[['total_nights', 'adr']]

# Compute correlation matrix
correlation_matrix = stay_adr_df.corr()

# Display correlation value
print("Correlation between total_nights and adr:")
print(correlation_matrix)

# Plot heatmap
plt.figure(figsize=(5, 4))
sns.heatmap(correlation_matrix, annot=True, cmap='coolwarm', fmt='.2f', square=True
plt.title("Correlation Heatmap: Total Nights vs ADR")
```

```
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```

```
Correlation between total_nights and adr:
              total_nights       adr
total_nights      1.000000  0.067945
adr               0.067945  1.000000
```

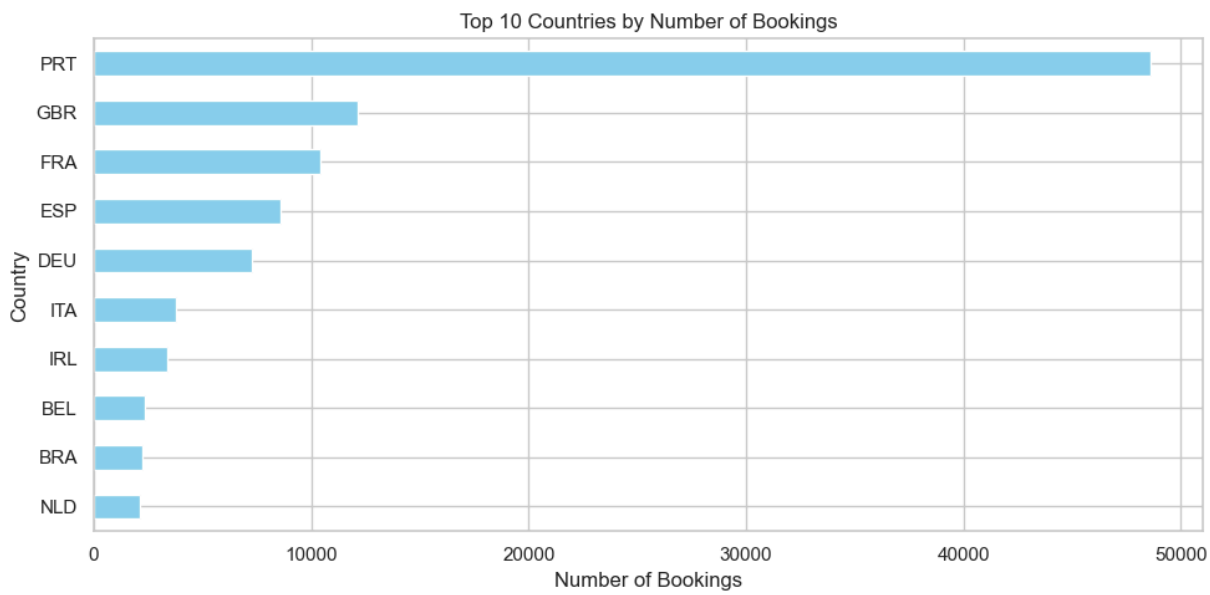


The correlation between stay length and ADR is weak overall. While it is expected0 to get discounts for longer stays, the dataset shows that both short and long stays can have high or low rates.

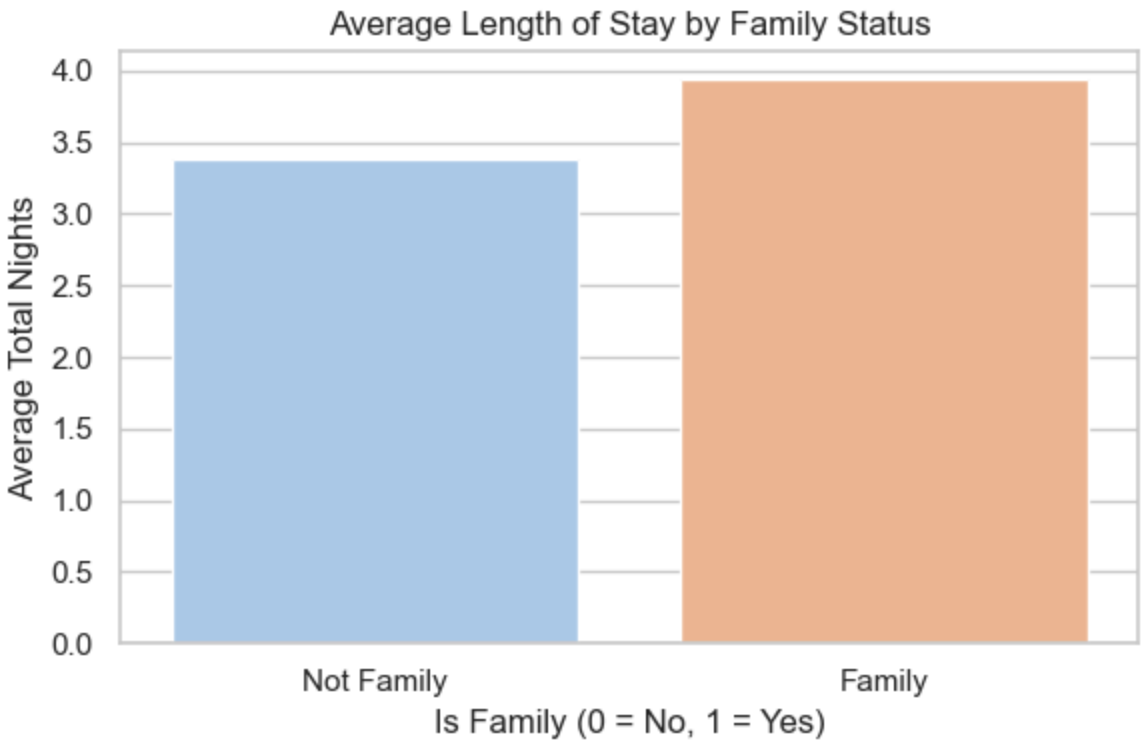
6.What demographic factors influence booking patterns?

In [62]:
```
#1.Top 10 Countries by Number of Bookings
top_countries = df['country'].value_counts().head(10).sort_values(ascending=True)#

plt.figure(figsize=(10, 5))
top_countries.plot(kind='barh', color='skyblue')#kind='barh' creates a horizontal b
plt.title('Top 10 Countries by Number of Bookings')
plt.xlabel('Number of Bookings')
plt.ylabel('Country')
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()

# 2. Create a new column to identify "family" bookings
# A family booking is defined as having at least one child or baby
df['is_family'] = ((df['children'] + df['babies']) > 0).astype(int)# condition to c
```

```
# 3. Compare length of stay by family status

df['total_nights'] = df['stays_in_week_nights'] + df['stays_in_weekend_nights']

family_stay = df.groupby('is_family')['total_nights'].mean().reset_index()

plt.figure(figsize=(6, 4))
sns.barplot(x='is_family', y='total_nights', data=family_stay, palette='pastel')
plt.title('Average Length of Stay by Family Status')
plt.xlabel('Is Family (0 = No, 1 = Yes)')
plt.ylabel('Average Total Nights')
plt.xticks([0, 1], ['Not Family', 'Family'])
plt.tight_layout()
plt.show()
```




```
C:\Users\Aksh Modgill\AppData\Local\Temp\ipykernel_18076\938557948.py:24: FutureWarn
ing:

Passing `palette` without assigning `hue` is deprecated and will be removed in v0.1
4.0. Assign the `x` variable to `hue` and set `legend=False` for the same effect.

  sns.barplot(x='is_family', y='total_nights', data=family_stay, palette='pastel')
```



Portugal (PRT) has by far the highest number of bookings, followed by the UK, France, Spain, and Germany. These top 5 countries represent a significant portion of all bookings in the dataset.

Family guests (i.e., those with children or babies) tend to stay longer than solo or adult only travelers. This is expected as families often book long vacations, not just overnight stays.